

paid for the stock, and, second, he would not settle for small profits. At the wise age of 11, Buffett had already learned one of the most important lessons in investing—patience. (More about this crucial quality in Chapter 7.)

In 1942, when Buffett was 12, his father was elected to the U.S. Congress and moved the family to Washington. The change was hard on the young boy. Miserable and hopelessly homesick, he was allowed to return to Omaha for a year, to live with his grandfather and Aunt Alice. The following year, 1943, Warren gave Washington another chance.

With no friendly brokerage firms to hang out in, gradually Buffett's interest moved away from the stock market and toward entrepreneurial ventures. At age 13, he was working two paper routes, delivering the *Washington Post* and the *Washington Times-Herald*. At Woodrow Wilson High School, he made friends with Don Danly, who quickly became infected with Buffett's enthusiasm for making money. The two pooled their savings and bought reconditioned pinball machines for \$25. Buffett convinced a local barber to let them put a machine in his shop for half the profits. After the first day of operation, they returned to find \$4 in nickels in their very first machine. The Wilson Coin-Operated Machine Company expanded to seven machines, and soon Buffett was taking home \$50 per week.

By the time Buffett graduated from high school, his savings from various endeavors totaled \$9,000. He promptly announced that he saw no reason to go to college, as it would interfere with his business ventures. His father overruled him, and by the fall Buffett found himself enrolled at the University of Pennsylvania's Wharton School of Business and Finance. Despite Wharton's emphasis on business and finance, Buffett was unimpressed with the university. "Not exactly turned on by it," he confessed; "it didn't seem like I was learning a lot."¹³ The Wharton curriculum stressed the theoretical aspects of business; what interested Buffett were the practical aspects of a business—how to make money. After two years at Wharton (1947–1949), he transferred to the University of Nebraska. He took 14 courses in one year and graduated in 1950. He was not yet 20 years old.